

CAPE TOWN, SOUTH AFRICA → SA, HYBRID, OR FULLY REMOTE →
UK / EUROPE TIMEZONE-FRIENDLY • BRITISH PASSPORT

ABOUT

SUMMARY

I build AI-powered internal tools, developer productivity systems and platform automations that help engineering teams move faster with more confidence - on DevOps foundations that run in production.

The career arc is intentional: Senior Software Quality Analyst and SDET, then DevOps, platform engineering and GenAIOps, now building the AI layer at scale - enterprise PR review, developer support tooling, adoption and cost telemetry, and thirteen consumer products shipped solo. The QA roots are why my AI work runs in production, not just in demos.

CAREER ARC

PHASE 01

Software Quality Analyst

Derivco • Durban → Cape Town • 2015 – 2022

Functional, regression, and performance testing across iGaming releases. Mentored junior QA, built CI/CD pipeline test integrations.

PHASE 02

SDET

Derivco • Cape Town • 2022 – 2023

C# / Selenium / PyTest / Playwright test frameworks for iGaming and Backoffice. Pipeline ownership and rapid response.

PHASE 03

Senior SQA

BET Software • Cape Town • 2023 – 2024

QA leadership across multiple products. Test automation strategy, CI/CD efficiency, end-to-end frameworks.

PHASE 04

DevOps + Applied AI

BET Software • Cape Town • 2024 – present

CI/CD, GenAIOps, enterprise AI PR review, support tooling, AI platform engineering and migration automation.

WORK EXPERIENCE

06/2024 - present
CAPE TOWN
CURRENT

Intermediate DevOps Engineer
BET Software

- Implemented modular CI/CD pipelines with Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions; significantly improved build and deploy reliability and time.
- Authored PowerShell and Python automation for server health-checks, pipeline automation, and log cleanup - saving approx 40 hrs/month of operational toil.
- Built Ansible playbooks for config management, software deploys, and build-agent cleanup - reducing manual workload by approx 25 hrs/month.
- Hardened Kubernetes build agents with custom Dockerfiles and pipeline configurations; raised operational efficiency and stability.
- Integrated active Dynatrace monitoring into Microsoft Teams for real-time alerts and proactive incident management.
- Curator of the DevOps Confluence space; authored extensive how-to guides and knowledge-sharing articles, reducing onboarding time for graduates and new starters.
- Automated JIRA task and epic workflows - structured creation, transitions, linking, and bulk updates - cutting manual ticketing overhead and keeping engineering work traceable end-to-end.

KEY PROJECTS · APPLIED AI + GENAIOPS

- ↳ Designed and rolled out AI-assisted PR reviews across hundreds of production repositories with GenAIOps controls: schema validation, severity gating, staged rollout, kill switches, cost telemetry and production monitoring.
- ↳ Built a unified DevOps support toolkit (CLI + REST API), VS Code chat participant, Atlassian assistant, and Kafka AI deployment workflow.
- ↳ Automated a ~3,400-game casino catalog's metadata extraction and uptime verification with Playwright and a locally-hosted vision model - collapsing an estimated 5-7 person-weeks of manual transcription per refresh into 2-3 days unattended, at zero inference cost.
- ↳ Modular CI/CD YAML pipelines with conditional Docker setups and isolated deploys; GitHub Actions → ADO migration with auto-PR rewrite tooling.
- ↳ Fully automated BI & Finance pipelines: dacpac artifacts, server health-checks, test suites, and secure approval gates (the company had none prior).
- ↳ Custom SonarQube reporting pipelines that auto-generate Excel reports and graphs for Head of Software & SLT, auto-committed to ADO via Git.

STACK: AZURE DEVOPS, GITHUB ACTIONS, PYTHON, POWERSHELL, ANSIBLE, KUBERNETES, DOCKER, ARGOCO, DYNATRACE, SONARQUBE, CONFLUENCE, CLAUDE / OPENAI / ELEVENLABS APIS

06/2023 -
06/2024

CAPE TOWN

1 YR

Senior Software Quality Analyst

BET Software

- ↳ Championed and maintained QA environments across several products.
- ↳ Spearheaded test automation initiatives to enhance CI/CD efficiency and reduce live-issue and deployment risk.
- ↳ Created comprehensive reusable, automatable test packs and aided in the creation of end-to-end testing frameworks covering functional, performance, and integrated security testing.
- ↳ Drove pipeline-integrated quality gates so a green build genuinely meant ready-to-deploy.

STACK: PYTHON, PYTEST, POWERSHELL, POSTMAN, SQL SERVER, AZURE DEVOPS, GIT, DOCKER, ELASTIC, GRAFANA, JIRA, SELENIUM, PLAYWRIGHT, ZENDESK

02/2022 -
07/2023

CAPE TOWN

1.5 YRS

Software Development Engineer in Test (SDET)

Derivco

- ↳ Developed and maintained automated test frameworks for iGaming and Backoffice applications.
- ↳ Implemented and executed test automation using C#, Selenium, PyTest, and Playwright frameworks.
- ↳ Incorporated AI-powered automation strategies to optimise software-testing procedures.
- ↳ Owned build and release pipelines, emphasising reliability and maintainability.
- ↳ Member of the Rapid Response team for production incident triage.

STACK: AZURE DEVOPS, AZURE TEST PLANS, SELENIUM, JAVASCRIPT, OCTOPUS DEPLOY, OWASP, C#, POWERSHELL, SQL SERVER

11/2015 -
02/2022

DURBAN

6.3 YRS

Software Quality Analyst

Derivco

- ↳ Executed functional, regression, and performance testing for software releases.
- ↳ Conducted performance testing using JMeter and Locust to optimise system efficiency.
- ↳ Improved CI/CD pipeline efficiency through test-automation integration.
- ↳ Facilitated agile processes and mentored junior QA staff.
- ↳ Designed end-to-end CI/CD pipelines automating ephemeral environments in Axiom: web app, backend service, database, and configuration deployment; automated installation of casino games

and back-office software, creation and funding of test user accounts, and execution of integrated test suites - reducing manual overhead substantially.

STACK: AZURE DEVOPS, POSTMAN, POWERSHELL, SQL SERVER, LAUNCHDARKLY, IIS, VMWARE

INDEPENDENT PRODUCTS & SIDE PROJECTS

SOLO WORK

Hadeda Havoc, Fettle, izwi, PowerMeter, ShotKit - thirteen consumer products built solo, several live: a paid arcade game on the iOS App Store, a smart tool-catalog app in TestFlight, a language app on iOS and Android, and multi-tenant web apps. End-to-end ownership: edge architecture, mobile, billing, store deployment, and CI quality gates with Playwright. Real users and real production constraints - the kind of hardening that takes a demo to a live app.

ADO → GitHub migration platform - production-grade, enterprise-scale, open source. Source freezing, parity validation, retryable batches, and audit reports. Built around the parts of migration that demos skip.

AI platform lab - a local-first AI platform run as daily infrastructure on a single 12 GB GPU: quantized local LLMs, Whisper/Kokoro voice, RAG memory over Qdrant, and a least-privilege personal agent with tool allowlists, tiered approvals, and audit trails. Where enterprise AI platform patterns get proven cheaply before they ship at work.

SELECTED TALKS

TALK

System Resilience: Engineering for Reliability - BET Masterclass Episode 3, February 2026. Practical approaches to designing systems that remain reliable under pressure: incident response, observability, and using AI to manage incidents calmly. youtu.be/s-2zqj-200A

SKILLS

CI/CD, INFRASTRUCTURE & SECRETS

Azure DevOps · GitHub Actions · IIS · Kubernetes · Docker · ArgoCD · Octopus Deploy · Helm · Terraform · RHEL OpenShift · HashiCorp Vault

TESTING & QUALITY ENGINEERING

Playwright · Maestro · PyTest · Selenium · Vitest / Jest · Postman · JMeter · Locust · Load / functional / regression / API / mobile / exploratory

MONITORING & OBSERVABILITY

Dynatrace · Grafana · ELK (Elastic) · Datadog · SonarQube

AUTOMATION, SCRIPTING & WORKFLOW

Python · PowerShell · TypeScript / JavaScript · Ansible · YAML · Bash · C# · Microsoft Power Automate · n8n

DOCUMENTATION & COLLABORATION

Confluence (curator of multiple spaces) · JIRA · Agile / SCRUM · Knowledge-base authoring

GENAIOPS & AI ENGINEERING

GenAIOps · Claude · OpenAI · Google · Local LLMs/VLMs · MCP · Agents · RAG · Evaluation · Observability · Cost telemetry

TEST MANAGEMENT & CASE PLATFORMS

Azure Test Plans · Zephyr Scale · Test Rail · JIRA (test workflows + task/epic automation) · Postman Collections · ISTQB-aligned test design

CLOUD & PLATFORMS

Azure · Cloudflare Workers · Windows Server · RHEL OpenShift · Linux administration · VMware vSphere / vCloud

APPLICATION STACKS

FastAPI · React Native · Vite · Tailwind · SQL Server · Kafka

STRENGTHS & OUTSIDE WORK

- ↳ **Outcome-first.** Specific over general. "Hundreds of production repositories" beats "large enterprise estate."
- ↳ **Sustainable engineering.** Automation that compounds over years, not automation that ships once and rots.
- ↳ **Honest about limits.** When the model's wrong, the UI says so. Over-claiming is what makes AI work feel sketchy.
- ↳ **Documentation as a deliverable.** Tools the rest of the team can read, run, and modify.
- ↳ **Mentorship.** A decade of QA leadership taught me that growing the people next to you is the highest-leverage thing you can do.

OUTSIDE WORK

Hiking 🏞️ FPV drones 🚁 Motorcycles 🏍️
Taekwon-do 🥋 Boxing 🥊 Coffee road-trips ☕
Tech & PC gaming 🎮 Agentic coding 🤖

References and recommendations available on LinkedIn or upon request.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

07/2024 - 04/2025	DevOps & Cloud training LinkedIn Learning · KodeKloud Academy
03/2018	ISTQB® Advanced Level Test Analyst SQS · Information Technology, Testing
03/2015	ISTQB® Certified Foundation Level Tester ISEB · Information Technology, Testing
2020	LinkedIn Learning - foundations AI Foundations: Machine Learning · DevOps Foundations: Containers · Git Essential Training · C# Essential Training
2003 - 2006	Bachelor of Arts (BA) - Psychology, Communications, English Varsity College
2002	Matriculated Westville Boys' High School

Thank you for taking the time to read through my CV - I genuinely appreciate it.
I'd welcome a conversation about how my experience could fit your team.

🌐 <https://www.stewart-burton.com>